



WHAT CAN THE NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER DO FOR YOU?

PRESENTED BY THE NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER STAFF
APRIL 27, 2-3PM ET.



WWW.THINKCOLLEGE.NET

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Overview of this session

- Welcome and Overview of NCC Mission and Key Leadership Activities
 - Debra Hart, MS and Meg Grigal, Ph.D, Principal Investigators
 - Cate Weir, M.Ed., NCC Project Coordinator
- Evaluation and Research
 - Clare Papay, Ph.D., Evaluation Coordinator
- Technical Assistance
 - Kathleen Becht, Ph.D, Technical Assistance Coordinator
- Dissemination and Knowledge Translation
 - Rebecca Lazo, Knowledge Translation Manager

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NCC Leadership Team



Meg Grigal
Principal Investigator



Debra Hart
Co-Principal Investigator



Cate Weir
Project Coordinator



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ThinkCollege
NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER
INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

Federally funded since 2010 to coordinate data collection with TPSID projects and to provide training and technical assistance to colleges, universities, students, families, transition professionals and K-12 educators who are interested in postsecondary education opportunities for students with intellectual disability.

www.thinkcollege.net

*College
options for
people with
intellectual
disability*



ThinkCollege
CHANGING EXPECTATIONS. INCREASING OPPORTUNITIES.

🔍 COLLEGE SEARCH

📖 RESOURCE LIBRARY

⇌ INNOVATION EXCHANGE

📖 WHAT'S HAPPENING IN YOUR STATE

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Our Goals

Provide	Provide leadership at a national level
Inform	Inform state and federal policy
Conduct	Conduct outreach/disseminate to new audiences
Offer	Offer guidance and assistance to stakeholders
Collaborate	Collaborate with other related centers and organizations

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Leadership & Policy Development

Sharing data and issues with Department of Education leaders

Providing updates to members of Congress and staffers

Supporting state policy development

Addressing capacity building needs in underserved states

Developing Program Accreditation process



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Outreach and Dissemination

 Partnerships with AHEAD and AUCD

 Collaborate with NTACT:C

 Assist doctoral researchers

 Sponsor students to attend annual Disability Policy Summit

 Sponsor the State of the Art Conference



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Being a voice for change



PUBLISHING
JOURNAL
ARTICLES IN
DIVERSE
PUBLICATIONS



DEVELOPING
MEDIA TOOLS
(PSAS, SHORT
FILMS)



TALKING WITH
JOURNALISTS
ABOUT INCLUSIVE
HIGHER
EDUCATION



SHARING AT
CONFERENCES
AND OTHER
EVENTS

**What does college have to offer
youth with intellectual disabilities?
Ask these young men.**



Why should I keep getting Social Security if I'm able and willing to work? I'd rather work for my money than get it for free.

By having these internship experiences, I've been able to make connections that I never would have thought possible.



I completed my college program and landed a full-time job at Amazon—with benefits!



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Focus on Policy

In this section of the website, find out...

- Who to contact with questions about college options for students with ID in your state
- Information about statewide or regional consortia in your state
- State-level policy and legislation

What's Happening in Your State



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Find the college that's right for you!

The only national database of college programs for students with intellectual disability

Think College Search

FAVORITES
Click "♥ save" to add programs to your favorites. You can then save, compare and download basic information for each one. See FAQ: How do I save and compare programs?

RECENTLY ADDED

- Alabama A&M University
- Arkansas State University
- Bridgewater State University (MA)
- Gwynedd Mercy University (PA)
- University of Oklahoma
- Texas A&M University

SEARCH

LOCATION

- ☐ Alabama (7)
- ☐ Alaska (1)
- ☐ Arizona (2)
- ▼ Show more states

PROGRAM FEATURES

- ☐ Serves Students in High School *
- ☐ Offers Financial Aid
- ☐ Offers Housing
- ☐ Program not limited by students' school districts

*Note that students who are dually enrolled might not be eligible for financial aid or housing

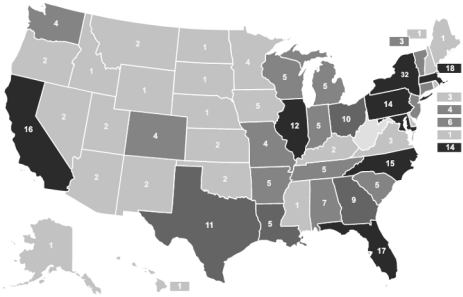
ADVANCED FILTERS

Find the College that is right for you!

This directory includes information on 279 college programs for students with intellectual disability. You can search by program name, location, and other keywords. "Advanced Filters" offer more options to narrow your search.

Review these Frequently Asked Questions for answers to some general questions on college programs, how we gather the information in the directory, and how to use the features of College Search.

Once you have located colleges you are interested in, download the How to Think College Guide to Conducting a College Search (PDF). It provides you with the right questions to ask in order to get the answers you need about each program on your list. The How To guide is also available in Spanish.



NUMBER OF PROGRAMS

0 1-3 4-6 7-9 10+

The information included here was submitted to Think College by the college programs. Being listed here does not indicate or imply a Think College endorsement. There also may be programs available that have not reported to us. All programs listed here must be affiliated with an accredited college or university and serve students with intellectual disabilities. To let us know about a new program, or to make changes to an existing program, please email thinkcollege@umb.edu.

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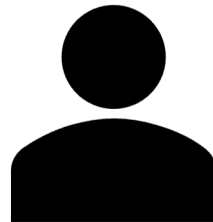
Evaluation Team Members



Clare Papay

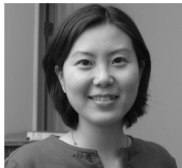


Pam McFarland



NOW HIRING!

Our consultants:



Xiaoying Wu



Mabel Liang



Frank Smith

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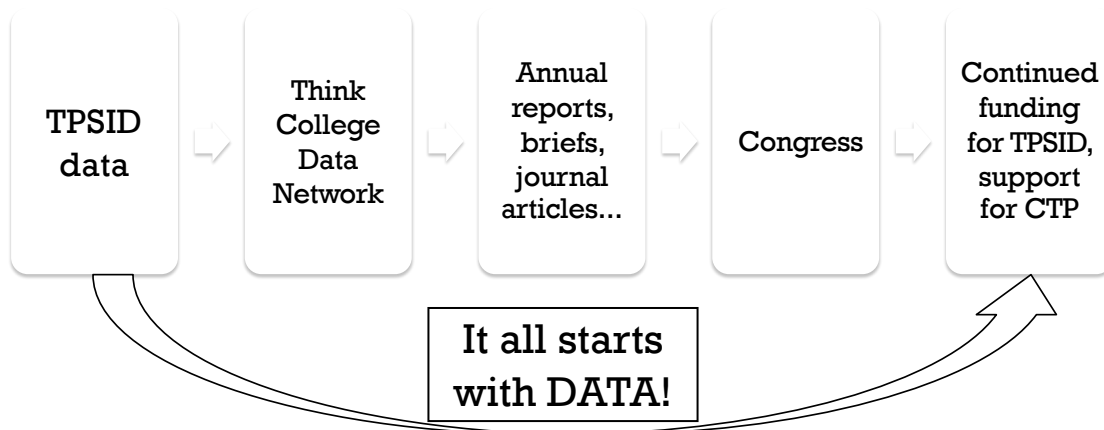
Our goals

- Capture & share TPSID data
- Help TPSIDs use data to improve services
- Share what we've learned from TPSID data with field at large
- Build collaborative opportunities to share research practices and findings



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Data Driven Reporting and Advocacy



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Data the NCC collects from TPSIDs



Program data

For example:

Operation
Partners
Charges
Staff



Student data

For example:

Core data (collected once)
Annual data (course enrollments,
jobs, etc)
Status at exit



Follow-up data

Once per year from each graduate

For example:

Employment
Further education
Living situation



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How we use TPSID data

YEAR FOUR ANNUAL REPORT OF THE TPSID MODEL DEMONSTRATION PROJECTS (2018–2019)



Annual report
published each year

- Program and student data
- Long term outcomes
- Trends over time

<https://thinkcollege.net/resources/think-college-publications>



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Going deeper...

- We've also looked at predictors of:
 - Employment
 - Enrollment in inclusive courses
- And conducted qualitative studies to understand:
 - Faculty perspectives
 - Employment supports



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As a result of these studies, we know....



Enrolling in specialized courses is negatively associated with both having paid employment in the program and enrolling in inclusive courses



Unpaid career development experiences are not a significant predictor of students obtaining paid employment during the program.



Students who obtained a paid job while enrolled are almost 15 times more likely to have a paid job at exit than those who do not



Students who have access to regular advising, earn an official transcript, or have a paid job enroll in more inclusive courses



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A brief synopsis of a study, piece of legislation, or policy or advocacy effort related to higher education for students with intellectual disability. This publication distills a big idea into a smaller, more manageable piece of information for a broad audience.

Research Affinity Group

Home / Technical Assistance / Affinity Groups / Research Affinity Group

Research Affinity Group



Welcome to the Think College Affinity Group on Research in Inclusive Higher Education

The purpose of the Affinity Group is to support members to:

- Learn about research that is happening in the field of inclusive higher education.
- Connect with each other and explore possible collaborations, and
- Share tools and resources.

This Affinity Group is designed for people who are currently involved in research in inclusive higher education or those who would like to become more involved. The activities of the group will be relevant for those working directly in inclusive higher education as well as in related disciplines (e.g., transition, rehabilitation, disability services). We have a particular focus on supporting emerging scholars (master's and doctoral candidates). At our meetings and other events, we explore current research agendas, tools, findings, needs, and challenges related to inclusive higher education.

AFFINITY GROUP FACILITATOR



Clare Papay, Ph.D.
Senior Research Associate at
Think College
clare.papay@umb.edu

NEXT MEETING

Our next meeting will be held May 18, 2021 at 1pm. You may join the meeting here; meeting agenda and notes may be found here.

NOTES FROM PAST MEETINGS

- Quarterly meetings with community of researchers
- <https://thinkcollege.net/technical-assistance/affinity-groups/research>



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Training & Technical Assistance

TA Team Members:



Kathy Becht



Cate Weir

Technical Assistance Coordinator Project Coordinator

14 State & National Consultants

<https://thinkcollege.net/technical-assistance/technical-assistance-providers>



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Training & Technical Assistance

External Consultants:

Denise Rozell, J.D., AUCD
 Margo Izzo, Ph.D., The Ohio State University
 Brian Freedman, Ph.D., University of Delaware,
 Kelly Kelley, Ph.D., Western Carolina University
 Susanna Miller-Raines, Georgia State University
 Lisa Pluff, M.A., University of North Carolina
 Julie Lackey, Lead, Learn, Live

Internal Consultants

Meg Grigal, Ph.D.
 Debra Hart, M.S.
 Clare Papay, Ph.D.
 Maria Paiewonsky, Ed.D.
 Russ Thelin, M.S., LVRC, CRC
 Lori Cooney, M. Ed.
 Ty Hanson, M.Ed.

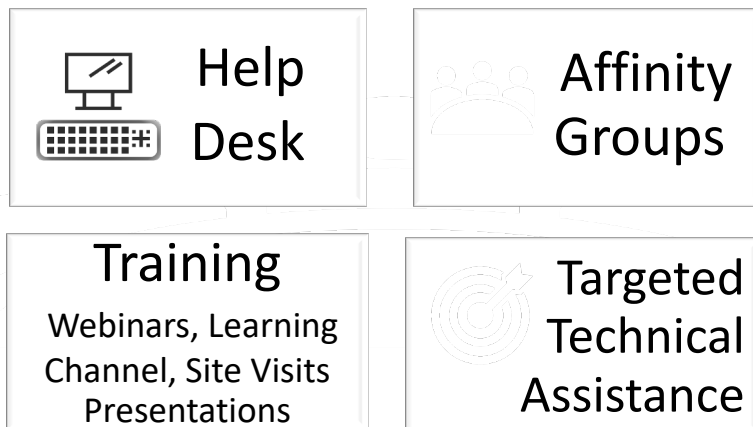
14 State & National Consultants

<https://thinkcollege.net/technical-assistance/technical-assistance-providers>



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Technical Assistance & Training Resources



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How can I help?



Help Desk

Ask us a Question or 2!

ThinkCollegeTA@gmail.com

Not sure who to contact? Email our Help Desk, where someone will respond to you in 24-48 hours!



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High School Transition Teacher



My administration is not thinking about college for my students, but I'd like to move in that direction. How do I plant the seed?

I've starting to hear from parents that they want more information about college. Where can I start?

I'd like to develop IEP goals to support college preparation. What can Think College offer?



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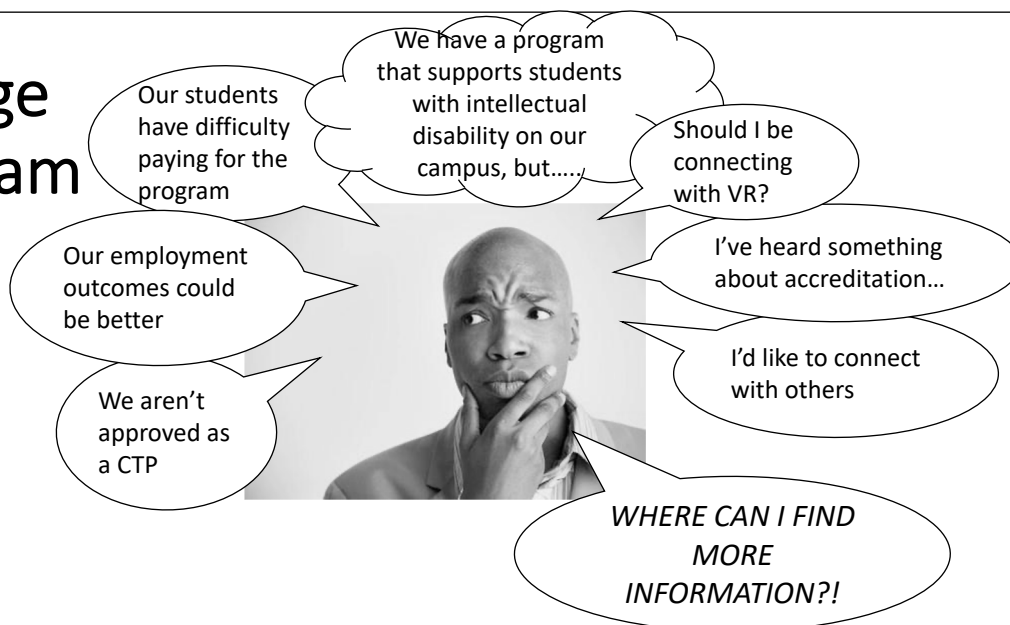
College Program Developer



I work at a college. How can I provide supports for students with intellectual disability. Where do I start?

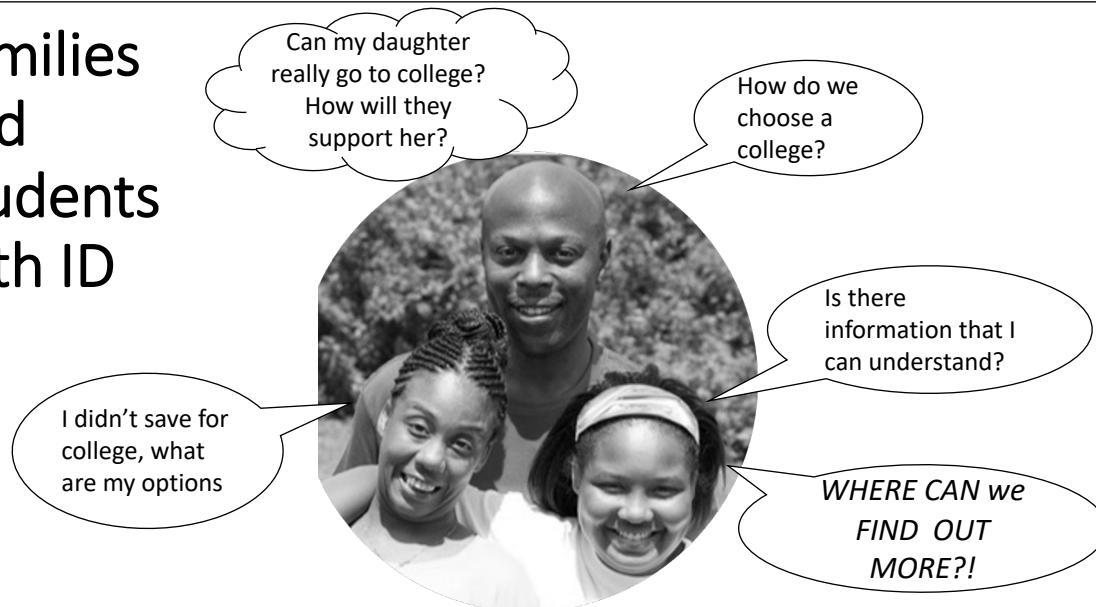
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College Program Staff



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Families and Students with ID



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Training & Targeted Technical Assistance

College-Based Transition
College & School District
Partnerships, Training for
School District Personnel,

State & Federal
Policy

Vocational
Rehabilitation &
WIOA

Program Development
College Living,
Academic Access &
Student Supports

Employment & Job
Supports

Credential
Development,
Program of Study

Family Awareness,
Parent Support, Family
Engagement

Accreditation
Preparation &
Program Evaluation

College Searches,
Preparing for College



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<https://thinkcollege.net/technical-assistance/think-college-affinity-groups>

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Knowledge Translation/Dissemination Team Members



Rebecca Lazo



Sheila Johnson

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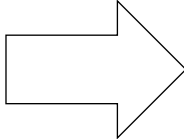
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Resources by Topic

We have carefully selected the following for each of these relevant topics:

- ✓ Timely, relevant articles
- ✓ Additional resources
- ✓ Frequently Asked Questions
- ✓ Quick Links



Academic Access
Campus Housing
College-based Transition Services
Comprehensive Transition & Postsecondary (CTP) Programs
Employment
For Families
Paying for College
Peer Mentors
Preparing for College
Program Accreditation
Program Development
Student Credential
Vocational Rehabilitation



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- Is your program doing something innovative or exciting?
- Do you have some research findings to share?
- Maybe you know a student who has achieved his or her goals?
- Do you have an upcoming event or course to announce?
- You may be doing a research project and need participants.

Whatever it is, we want to know! Contact Rebecca Lazo rebecca.lazo@umb.edu or email the Help Desk and we'll work with you to get the word out!



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OUTREACH

OVER
80K 
visitors to thinkcollege.net

4,000 
Twitter Followers


10,000+
Facebook Followers

1,400
Family Facebook group

400
Programs Facebook group

Social Media, Website, and more!

Each month we reach thousands of people with information and resources related to inclusive higher education.



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What's for Families?



Visit these spots on our website:

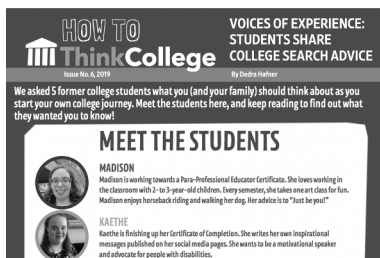
- Family Resources
- College Search
- What's Happening in Your State
- Thinkcollege.net homepage
- Resources by Topics:
 - For Families*
 - Paying for College*
 - Preparing for College*
- Sign up for our newsletter!

And don't forget the *Families Think College* Facebook group!



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Resources for students



We have publications designed with students in mind:

- By students, for students
- A wide range of stories by or about students & their experiences with transition, at college, or at work.
- Plain language guides



The Emerging Advocates group, led by Liz Weintraub from AUCD, meets quarterly to discuss advocacy, self-advocacy, and policy.

Coming soon!

We are working on a new page specifically for students, a one-stop shop for easy use. We'll feature publications, links to the Emerging Advocates group, webinars and videos, info on other organizations, and more. *Stay tuned!*



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**SESSION 2: WHERE ARE WE NOW:
PROGRAM ACCREDITATION STANDARDS**
Thursday, June 3, 2-3PM ET



PRESENTERS: MARTHA MOCK STEPHANIE SMITH LEE, & DEBRA
WWW.THINKCOLLEGE.NET

> REGISTER NOW



**SESSION 3: LESSONS LEARNED FROM
A DECADE OF DATA**
Thursday, June 29 @ 3-4 PM ET



PRESENTERS: MEG GRIGAL & CLARE PAPAY
WWW.THINKCOLLEGE.NET

> REGISTER NOW

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PLEASE keep in touch.

There are numerous ways to connect with Think College:

- Follow us on social media
- Join one of our Facebook groups
- Sign up for our mailing list
- Bookmark our website


Join our Mailing List

Think College: Changing Expectations. Increasing Opportunities.

Sign up for the Think College mailing list to receive our Monthly Newsletter and other updates right to your inbox.

What's in our News & Updates newsletter?

- The latest happenings at the National Coordinating Center
- Links to recent publications and upcoming events
- News from our partners: AUCD, AHEAD, and PACER's National Parent Center on Transition & Employment
- Federal and State legislative updates affecting postsecondary education
- News and information about postsecondary education from around the country

Sign up to stay in touch!

Sign up to get interesting news and updates from Think College delivered to your inbox.

Email Address

First Name

Last Name

City

Select a state/province

Job Title

Sign Up

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